

Identical Rooms



Identifiability

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Structure - Architecture of Assumption



Identifiability



We use observed data to gain information about unobserved components. Some of a model's internal components might be set arbitrarily or interchangeably without inviting contradiction by observations.



structural degeneracy, redundant parameters, nullspaces, equivalence, indistinguishable mechanisms



Reveals symmetry and ambiguity of explanation.



Obscures causality; breeds indifference to structure.



For target card, ask which other effect might produce the same results.



"What distinctions do you honor that the data cannot see?"



For a long time, they wandered from room to room, each identical to the last. They began to suspect the world repeated itself until one of them noticed the candles flickering in the draft.

